ENHANCING COLLABORATION: ALIGNING MENTOR / MENTEE EXPECTATIONS

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Download presentation at https://tinyurl.com/Mentoring-GSO

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Jane Lehr (she, her, hers)



Top 5 Strengths: Learner, Arranger, Individualization, Analytical, Responsibility

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Office of Student Research

1. Increase transparency of access for student research opportunities in all disciplines (on- and off-campus)
2. Work with Colleges to enhance their existing programs and build capacity in new areas
3. Support the professional development of mentors and mentees, including attention to diversity, equity & inclusion in student research contexts
4. Increase the funding available to support student research

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Overview

1. Mentor Roles in Graduate Education
2. Aligning Expectations in New Mentoring Relationships
3. Equity-Mindedness & Student Research Participation
4. Resources

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Mentor Roles in Graduate Education

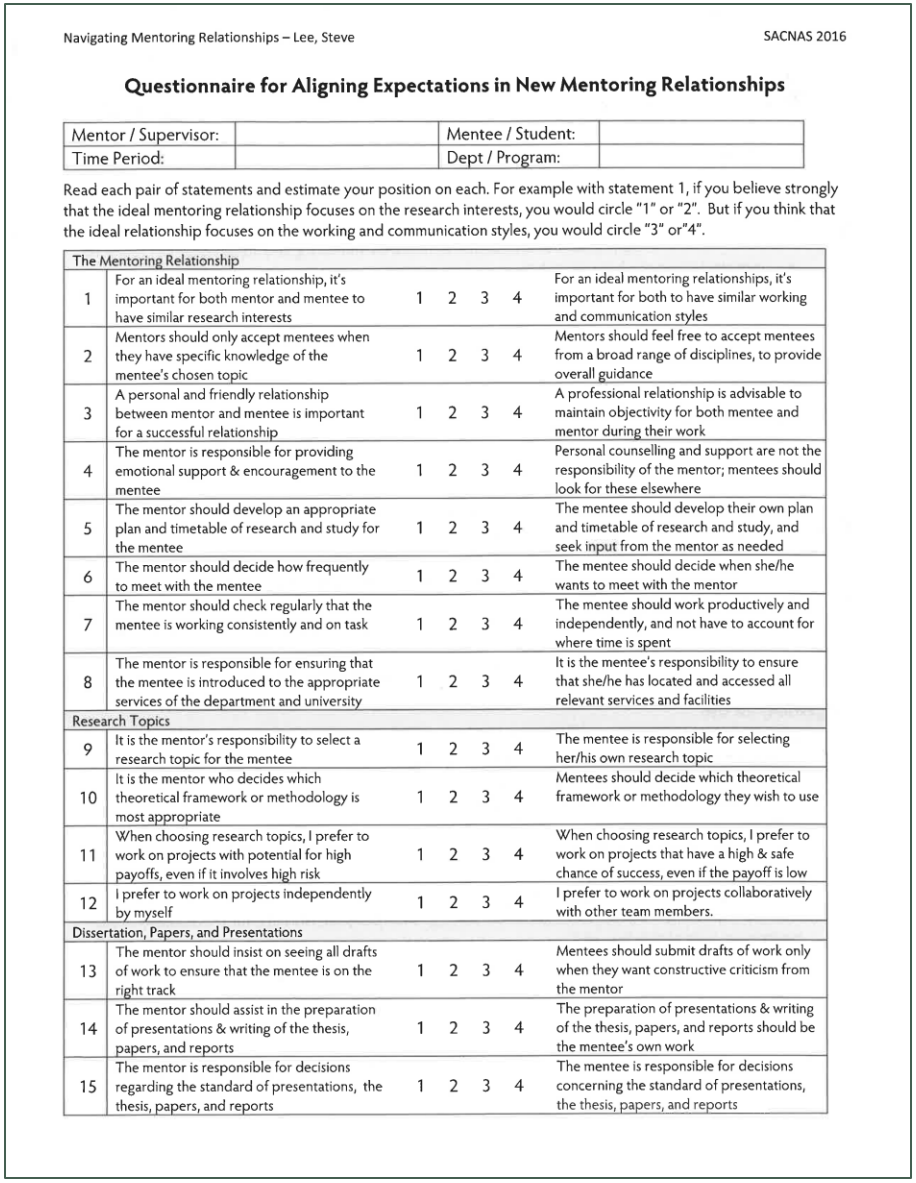
1. **Advisers**, people with career experience willing to share their knowledge
2. **Supporters**, people who give emotional and moral encouragement
3. **Tutors**, people who give specific feedback on one's performance
4. **Masters**, in the sense of employers to whom one is apprenticed
5. **Sponsors**, sources of information about, and aid in obtaining opportunities
6. **Models of identity**, of the kind of person one should be to an academic

- Zelditch, M. (1990). Mentor roles. Proceedings of the 32nd Annual Meeting of the Western Association of Graduate Schools, Tempe, Arizona, 16-18 March, 1990, p. 11.

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Aligning Expectations in New Mentoring Relationships

https://tinyurl.com/aligningExpectations



Navigating Mentoring Relationships – Lee, Steve SACNAS 2016

Questionnaire for Aligning Expectations in New Mentoring Relationships

Mentor / Supervisor:		Mentee / Student:	
Time Period:		Dept / Program:	

Read each pair of statements and estimate your position on each. For example with statement 1, if you believe strongly that the ideal mentoring relationship focuses on the research interests, you would circle "1" or "2". But if you think that the ideal relationship focuses on the working and communication styles, you would circle "3" or"4".

The Mentoring Relationship						
1	For an ideal mentoring relationship, it's important for both mentor and mentee to have similar research interests	1	2	3	4	For an ideal mentoring relationships, it's important for both to have similar working and communication styles
2	Mentors should only accept mentees when they have specific knowledge of the mentee's chosen topic	1	2	3	4	Mentors should feel free to accept mentees from a broad range of disciplines, to provide overall guidance
3	A personal and friendly relationship between mentor and mentee is important for a successful relationship	1	2	3	4	A professional relationship is advisable to maintain objectivity for both mentee and mentor during their work
4	The mentor is responsible for providing emotional support & encouragement to the mentee	1	2	3	4	Personal counselling and support are not the responsibility of the mentor; mentees should look for these elsewhere
5	The mentor should develop an appropriate plan and timetable of research and study for the mentee	1	2	3	4	The mentee should develop their own plan and timetable of research and study, and seek input from the mentor as needed
6	The mentor should decide how frequently to meet with the mentee	1	2	3	4	The mentee should decide when she/he wants to meet with the mentor
7	The mentor should check regularly that the mentee is working consistently and on task	1	2	3	4	The mentee should work productively and independently, and not have to account for where time is spent
8	The mentor is responsible for ensuring that the mentee is introduced to the appropriate services of the department and university	1	2	3	4	It is the mentee's responsibility to ensure that she/he has located and accessed all relevant services and facilities
Research Topics						
9	It is the mentor's responsibility to select a research topic for the mentee	1	2	3	4	The mentee is responsible for selecting her/his own research topic
10	It is the mentor who decides which theoretical framework or methodology is most appropriate	1	2	3	4	Mentees should decide which theoretical framework or methodology they wish to use
11	When choosing research topics, I prefer to work on projects with potential for high payoffs, even if it involves high risk	1	2	3	4	When choosing research topics, I prefer to work on projects that have a high & safe chance of success, even if the payoff is low
12	I prefer to work on projects independently by myself	1	2	3	4	I prefer to work on projects collaboratively with other team members.
Dissertation, Papers, and Presentations						
13	The mentor should insist on seeing all drafts of work to ensure that the mentee is on the right track	1	2	3	4	Mentees should submit drafts of work only when they want constructive criticism from the mentor
14	The mentor should assist in the preparation of presentations & writing of the thesis, papers, and reports	1	2	3	4	The preparation of presentations & writing of the thesis, papers, and reports should be the mentee's own work
15	The mentor is responsible for decisions regarding the standard of presentations, the thesis, papers, and reports	1	2	3	4	The mentee is responsible for decisions concerning the standard of presentations, the thesis, papers, and reports

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Practice: Aligning Expectations

3	A personal and friendly relationship between mentor and mentee is important for a successful relationship	1	2	3	4	A professional relationship is advisable to maintain objectivity for both mentee and mentor during their work
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1) By yourself: Read each pair of statements (pairs 3, 4, 9, 10, 13) and *quickly* estimate your position on each.
2) Pair share: Choose 2 statements (from these pairs) to discuss with the person next to you. Compare your responses
3) Large group discussion

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EQUITY-MINDEDNESS & STUDENT RESEARCH PARTICIPATION



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STRATEGIC PRIORITY 1: Enhance the Success of All Cal Poly Students

- **1A: Maintain and enhance Cal Poly's signature pedagogy of Learn by Doing.**
- 1B: Assure that all students attain the knowledge, skills and understanding to thrive in a diverse, evolving and competitive environment.
- 1C: Ensure access to an excellent education for all California students by providing financial aid support for those with the greatest economic need.
- 1D: Improve first-year and transfer student graduation rates and eliminate achievement gaps for all students to meet the goals of the CSU's Graduation Initiative 2025.
- **1E: Provide an additional high-impact experience* for every undergraduate student.**

* For a list of HIPs & impacts see https://www.aacu.org/sites/default/files/files/LEAP/HIP_tables.pdf

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STRATEGIC PRIORITY 3: Enrich the Campus Culture of Diversity, Equity and Inclusion

- 3A: Create an aligned and cohesive focus on diversity and inclusion across the university
- 3B: Create and sustain a more diverse, equitable and inclusive university community that reflects and serves the diverse people of California
- 3C: Prepare all students for their future through an education that includes diversity learning and reflects the principles of Inclusive Excellence
- 3D: Further develop a campus climate that reflects the values of diversity, equity and inclusion as well as free inquiry and mutual respect

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An Equity Frame

Table 8.1. Diversity, Deficit, and Equity Cognitive Frames Compared on Four Dimensions

	Diversity Cognitive Frame	*Deficit Cognitive Frame*	*Equity Cognitive Frame*
Orientation	Focus on the representation of differences (for example, gender, race, ethnicity, sexual orientation, religion, and so on) in the student body	Focus on stereotypical characteristics associated with the culture of disadvantage and poverty	Focus on institutional practices and the production of unequal educational outcomes for minority group students
Discourse	Celebrating diversity, crossracial relationships, and color-blindness, enhancing access, cognitive and social benefits of having a diverse student body	Lack of preparation, motivation, study skills, blaming students and/or their backgrounds	Institutional responsibility for student outcomes, the manifestation of institutionalized racism, color-conscious, awareness of racialized practices and their differential consequences, awareness of white privilege
Strategies	Workshops, sensitivity training, exposing whites to the "other," diversifying the curriculum, creating inter-cultural centers	Compensatory educational programs, remedial courses, special programs, all focused on fixing the student	Changing institutions, developing institutional accountability of equitable educational outcomes, changing individuals' cognitive frames

Bensimon, E. M. (2005). Closing the achievement gap in higher education: An organizational learning perspective. *New Directions for Higher Education*, 131. (note: this table from the 2005 publication is missing "guiding questions" as the fourth dimension)

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An Equity Frame

Equity Cognitive Frame
Focus on institutional practices and the production of unequal educational outcomes for minority group students
Institutional responsibility for student outcomes, the manifestation of institutionalized racism, color-conscious, awareness of racialized practices and their differential consequences, awareness of white privilege
Changing institutions, developing institutional accountability of equitable educational outcomes, changing individuals' cognitive frames

Bensimon, E. M. (2005). Closing the achievement gap in higher education: An organizational learning perspective. *New Directions for Higher Education*, 131. (note: this table from the 2005 publication is missing "guiding questions" as the fourth dimension)

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USC CUE Equity Mindedness

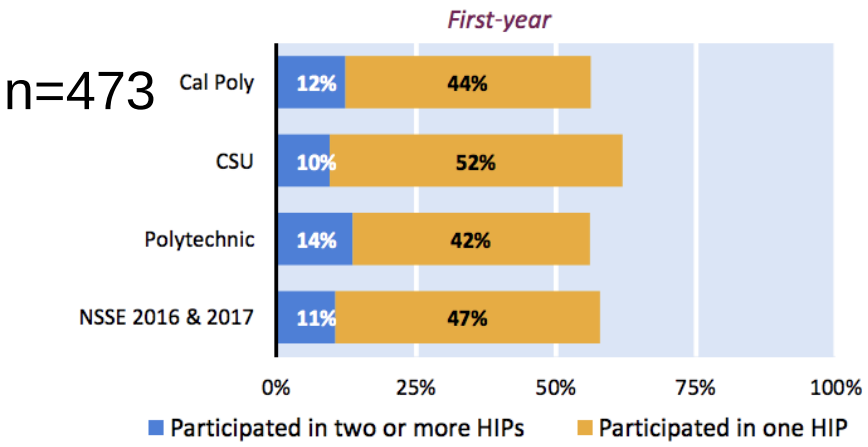
- In order to understand and become “Equity-Minded”, it warrants that various practitioners (faculty, administration, staff, etc.) assess and acknowledge that their practices may not be working.
- It takes understanding inequities as a dysfunction of the various structures, policies, and practices that they can control.
- “Equity-Minded” practitioners question their own assumptions, recognize stereotypes that harm student success, and continually reassess their practices to create change.
- Part of taking on this framework is that institutions and practitioners become accountable for the success of their students and see racial gaps as their personal and institutional responsibility.

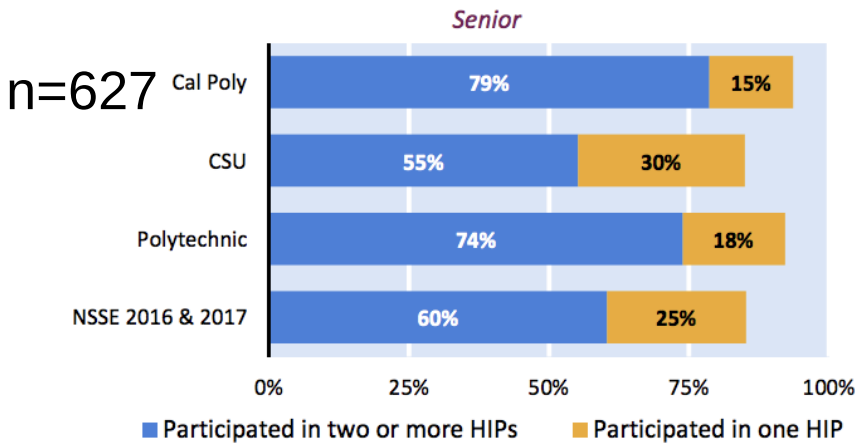


From 2017 National Survey on Student Engagement (NSSE) – Cal Poly vs. _____

Overall HIP Participation

The figures below display the percentage of students who participated in High-Impact Practices. Both figures include participation in service-learning, a learning community, and research with faculty. The senior figure also includes participation in an internship or field experience, study abroad, and culminating senior experience. The first segment in each bar shows the percentage who participated in at least two HIPs, and the full bar (both colors) represents the percentage who participated in at least one.





Polytechnic (N=18)
Clarkson University (Potsdam, NY) Clemson University (Clemson, SC)* Florida Institute of Technology (Melbourne, FL) Georgia Institute of Technology (Atlanta, GA) Iowa State University (Ames, IA)* Mississippi State University (Mississippi State, MS)* Missouri University of Science & Technology (Rolla, MO)* New Mexico Institute of Mining and Technology (Socorro, NM) Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute (Troy, NY) Rochester Institute of Technology (Rochester, NY) Stevens Institute of Technology (Hoboken, NJ) SUNY Polytechnic Institute (Utica, NY) Tennessee Technological University (Cookeville, TN) University of Northe rn Iowa (Cedar Falls, IA)* University of Wisconsin-Stout (Menomonie, WI) Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University (Blacksburg, VA) Wentworth Institute of Technology (Boston, MA) Worcester Polytechnic Institute (Worcester, MA)*

Statistical Comparisons

The table below displays the percentage of your students who participated in a given High-Impact Practice, including the percentage who participated overall (at least one, two or more). It also graphs the difference, in percentage points, between your students and those of your comparison groups. Blue bars indicate how much higher your institution's percentage is compared to the comparison group. Dark red bars indicate how much lower your institution's percentage is compared to the comparison group. (Comparison group percentages appear on the following pages.)

		Your students' participation compared with:								
	Cal Poly	**CSU**			**Polytechnic**			**NSSE 2016 & 2017**		
First-year	*%*	*Difference* [a]		*ES* [b]	*Difference* [a]		*ES* [b]	*Difference* [a]		*ES* [b]
12. **Service-Learning**	49	-10	***	-.19	+3		.05	-3		-.07
11c. **Learning Community**	17	+5	***	.14	-2		-.06	+3	*	.09
11e. **Research with Faculty**	4	+1		.04	-3	**	-.15	-1		-.04
Participated in at least one	56	-6	*	-.12	+0		.00	-2		-.03
Participated in two or more	12	+3	*	.09	-1		-.04	+2		.06
Senior										
12. **Service-Learning**	57	-8	***	-.17	+6	**	.12	-3		-.06
11c. **Learning Community**	20	-1		-.02	-7	***	-.17	-3	*	-.08
11e. **Research with Faculty**	36	+20	***	.46	+1		.02	+13	***	.29
11a. **Internship or Field Exp.**	65	+23	***	.48	-2		-.03	+16	***	.33
11d. **Study Abroad**	15	+9	***	.29	-5	**	-.12	+1		.04
11f. **Culminating Senior Exp.**	71	+32	***	.65	+16	***	.33	+26	***	.53
Participated in at least one	94	+9	***	.28	+1		.06	+8	***	.28
Participated in two or more	79	+23	***	.51	+5	**	.11	+18	***	.40

a. Percentage point differences (institution – comp. group) rounded to whole numbers. Values less than one may not display a bar and may be shown as +0 or -0.

b. Cohen's *h* (standardized difference between two proportions). Effect sizes indicate the practical importance of observed differences. For service-learning, internships, study abroad, and culminating senior experiences, an ES of about .2 may be considered small, .5 medium, and .8 large. For learning community and research with faculty, an ES of about .1 may be considered small, .3 medium, and .5 large (Rocconi & Gonyea, 2015).

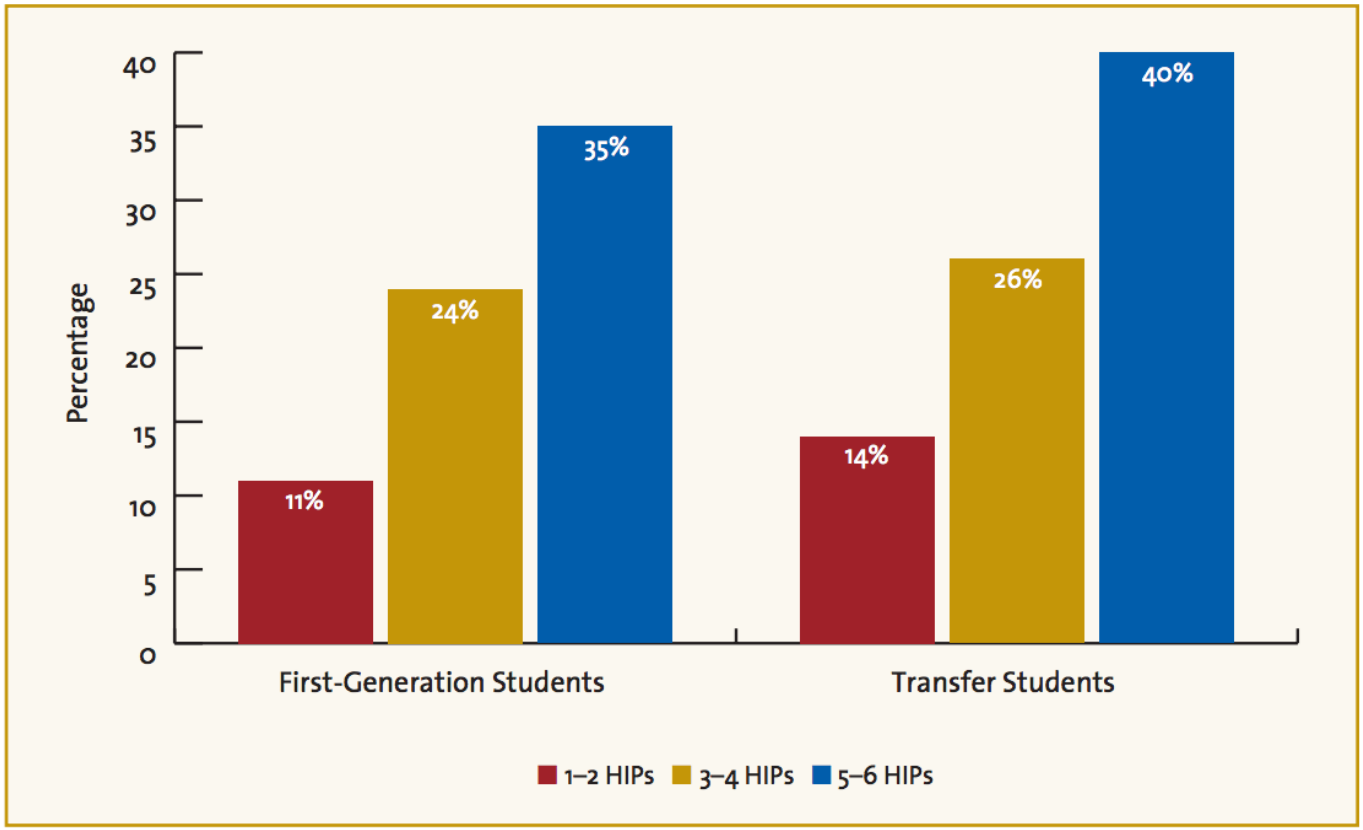
$*p < .05$, $**p < .01$, $***p < .001$ (z-test comparing participation rates).

Note: Participation includes the percentage of students who responded "Done or in progress" except for service-learning which is the percentage who responded that at least "Some" courses included a community-based project. All results weighted by institution-reported sex and enrollment status (and by institution size for comparison groups).

HIPs have an impact for students from minoritized groups

Source: Finley, A., and McNair, T. (2009). Assessing underserved students' engagement in high-impact practices. Association of American Colleges and Universities.

Within-Group Comparisons for First-Generation and Transfer Students: Average Boost in Deep Learning Experiences and Self-Reported Gains with Multiple High-Impact Practices (HIPs) vs. No Participation



However, national research on undergraduate research shows that …

- Students who are first generation, from low socioeconomic backgrounds, and/or from groups underrepresented in STEM are **less likely to participate** in undergraduate research experiences (Hurtado et al., 2011).
- When students from these groups do participate, they **face additional barriers** in participating in research projects, including an **unwelcoming/inhospitable research environment** (Hurtado et al., 2011).
- In addition, while inequitable/ineffective mentorship by faculty (plus graduate students plus post-docs) is identified as a contributing factor to an unwelcoming/inhospitable research environment in a number of studies, **relatively little research explores how faculty mentorship contributes to creating an unwelcoming environment** (Prunuske et al, 2013).

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Participation in High-Impact Practices by Student Characteristics

The table below displays the percentage of your students who participated in each HIP by selected student characteristics. Examining participation rates for different groups offers insight into how engagement varies within your student population.

	First-year			*Senior*					
	Service-Learning	Learning Community	Research with Faculty	Service-Learning	Learning Community	Research with Faculty	Internship or Field Experience	Study Abroad	Culminating Senior Experience
Sex[a]	%	%	%	%	%	%	%	%	%
Female	51	14	3	64	23	36	66	17	72
Male	46	20	5	52	17	37	64	13	70
Race/ethnicity or international[a]									
American Indian or Alaska Native	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Asian	38	10	6	65	26	35	63	14	67
Black or African American	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Hispanic or Latino	47	12	2	50	20	25	50	11	64
Native Hawaiian/Other Pac. Islander	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
White	51	18	4	60	20	38	71	18	75
Other	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Foreign or nonresident alien	80	10	0	73	18	18	45	0	45
Two or more races/ethnicities	40	19	0	60	14	44	63	14	67

White student respondents in their senior year reported a participation rate of 38% whereas Latinx respondents reported a participation rate of 25%.

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RESOURCES



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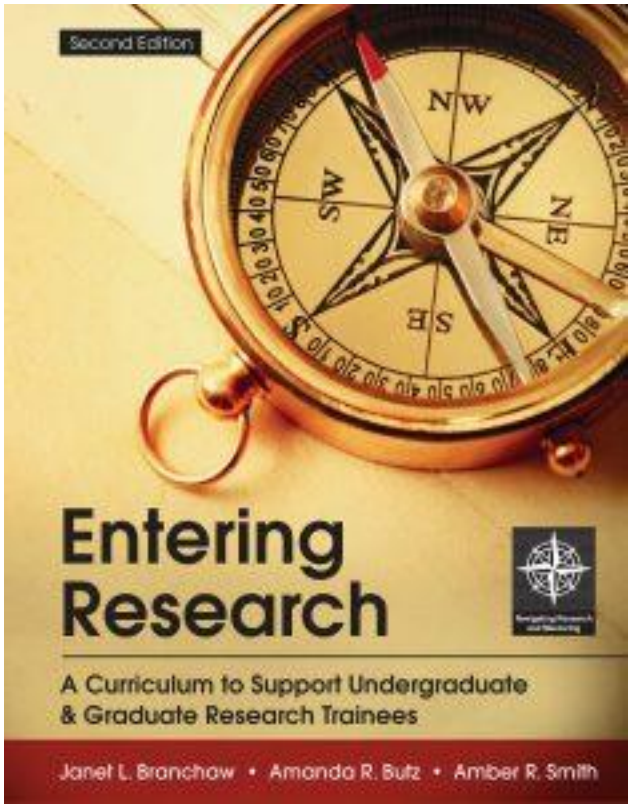
Center for the Improvement of Mentored Experiences in Research (CIMER)

- "One critical element of an effective mentor-mentee relationship is a shared understanding of what each person expects from the relationship. Problems between mentors and mentees often arise from misunderstandings about expectations. Importantly, expectations change over time, so frequent reflection and clear communication about expectations are needed on a regular basis."



Entering Research: A Curriculum to Support Undergraduate & Graduate Research Trainees

1. Research Comprehension & Communication Skills
2. Practical Research Skills
3. Research Ethics
4. Researcher Identity
5. Researcher Confidence & Independence
6. Equity & Inclusion Awareness & Skills Professional & Career Development Skills



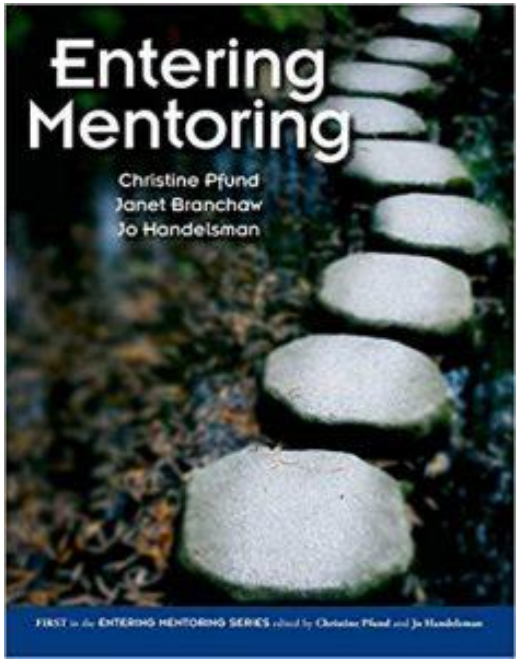
https://cimerproject.org/entering-research/

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Entering Mentoring

1. Aligning Expectations
2. Addressing Equity and Inclusion
3. Articulating Your Mentoring Philosophy and Plan
4. Assessing Understanding
5. Cultivating Ethical Behavior
6. Enhancing Work-Life Integration
7. Fostering Independence
8. Maintaining Effective Communication
9. Promoting Mentee Research Self-Efficacy
10. Promoting Professional Development

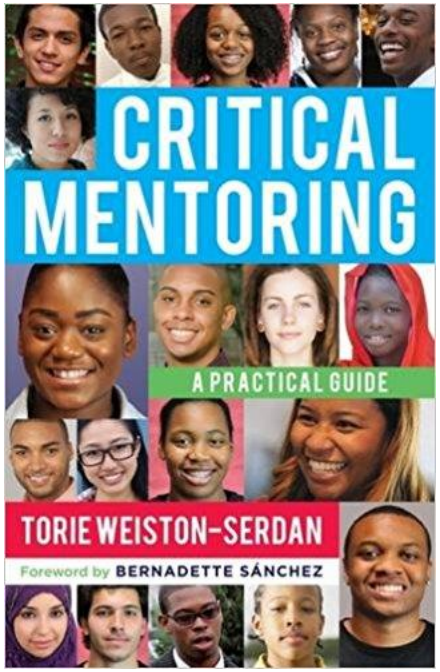


https://cimerproject.org/entering-mentoring/

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Critical Mentoring: A Practical Guide

- Torie Weiston-Serdan (2017) utilizes the framework of “critical mentoring” to “move mentoring research and praxis into a larger discourse around the critical examination of race, ethnicity, class, gender and sexuality as they pertain to mentoring.”
- This approach to mentoring challenges deficit-based approaches to mentoring – in which the mentee needs to be “fixed” to succeed within the academic or professional environment – and “seeks to engage both the mentor and the protégé in processes that trigger critical consciousness and an ongoing and joint struggle for transformation.”



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